

DUNG REMOVAL
Dung beetles are vital to the health of this ecosystem. They clear dung, recycle nutrients, and improve soil. As well as eating fresh dung, they roll it into balls and take it underground.

Home to 7,500 elephants in 2014

DUNG BEETLE AT WORK



STRATIFIED GRAZING
To avoid competing for food, grazing and browsing animals specialize in eating different plants or parts of plants. Zebras, for example, feed on older, tougher grasses than wildebeest, while giraffes browse from branches of acacia trees that no other animal can reach.

Occupies 14% of Tanzania's land area

GIRAFFE FEEDING ON ACACIA BRANCHES



THE ROLE OF FIRE
Lightening striking dry vegetation can cause fire. This does not kill grasses because their growing points are safe in the soil, but it can kill trees, thereby preventing woodland from forming. White storks hunt insects fleeing the fire.

White stork hunting



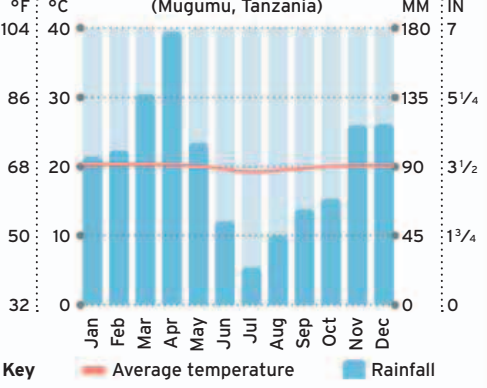
LOCATION

The Serengeti region covers 12,000 sq miles (31,000 sq km) of Kenya and Tanzania. The name is derived from a Masai term meaning endless plain.



CLIMATE

The climate is warm and dry, with two wet seasons: the short rains in November and December, and the long rains from March to May. The highest rainfall is in the west, near Lake Victoria, and lowest in the rain shadow of the Ngorongoro uplands to the southeast.



THE FAMOUS FIVE

Big game hunters used to visit the Serengeti with the aim of shooting and killing the "Big Five"—a lion, leopard, elephant, rhinoceros, and Cape buffalo. Today, most tourists want to see and photograph the wildlife, and the cheetah has replaced the buffalo in the top five.

